Adora.exe Has Stopped Working

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/67646101.

Rating:
Teen And Up Audiences

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She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

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by Auvronestra

Summary

Adora takes a hit in battle and spends the day a little... off. Confused, clumsy, and temporarily useless, she still somehow fumbles her way through the mission. Catra roasts her, Glimmer loses it, and Bow just tries to help.

The morning sun splashes golden light over Bright Moon Castle, but inside the war room, the vibe sits somewhere between a toddler's birthday party and a circus on fire. Adora slumps deep into Glimmer's throne's cushion, twirling a daisy chain like it holds the secrets of the universe. Her usual laser-sharp eyes have morphed into enormous, watery *orbs,* shimmering with pure puppy-level confusion. The last blow from Hordak still rings in her head like an awful ringtone—somewhere in the collision, her brain switched into *'total idiot mode'.*

Catra drapes herself on the throne's armrest, smirking with a glint that says *This is gonna be fun.* She pokes Adora's cheek gently, her grin stretching wider.

"Hey, Adora," she says, voice dripping with amused disbelief. "You just forgot how to *fight,* didn't you? You've got the battle instincts of a squirrel in a disco. Like, what are you even *doing?"* Her tail swishes in front of Adora's eyes. "Mew?" Adora blinks twice, then suddenly bursts into giggles, clutching the daisy chain tighter.

"Mew!" she chirps back, wobbling to stand, only to trip on her own feet and land in an ungraceful heap on the floor.

"Wow." Catra's lips twitch, holding back a laugh. "You're like a cute disaster on wheels."

The war room doors swing open with a dramatic *bang.* Glimmer storms in, magic crackling at her fingertips and annoyance radiating from every pore.

"Adora! You *cannot* just sit there like a cat that lost its yarn ball!"

"Hey," Catra protests mildly. Glimmer ignores her.

"We have a *war* to win! Hordak's troops are moving, and you're—this." She gestures helplessly at Adora sprawled on the floor. Bow shuffles in behind Glimmer, arms raised diplomatically.

"Now, Glimmer, maybe we should just—give her some time. Brain damage can mess with the uh… Adora software. Sometimes you just need a system reboot." Adora crawls over to Bow and wraps her arms around his knees, her voice dropping to a dreamy sing-song.

"Bow… If I squint really hard, do you think I could turn into a unicorn?" Bow snorts, brushing a stray hair behind her ear.

"I'd say keep the squinting minimal, yeah? Unicorns are hard to find, and your enemies aren't exactly going to wait." Glimmer groans, facepalm practically audible.

"This is hopeless." Suddenly, the communicator beeps loudly. Catra snatches it up, squinting at the screen.

"Hordak's troops were spotted near the western ridge. So… Queen of Disasters, wanna lead the charge?" Her grin turns devilish and Adora beams, her eyes sparkling with pure, unfocused enthusiasm. She bolts up, then immediately veers off to the left, tripping on the carpet and tumbling into a conveniently-placed stack of pillows.

"Whoops!" Catra pinches the bridge of her nose as she hauls Adora to her feet and wraps an arm around her shoulders with mock tenderness.

"Alright, hopeless as you are, you're *my* hopeless disaster. Let's drag you into this mess and see what happens." Glimmer sighs but cancels her magic, while Bow readies his weapon with a grin.

"Team Woobified Adora, assemble!"

Outside the castle, the air thrums with tension as the Horde advances. Adora stumbles forward, occasionally hugging Catra for balance or accidentally whacking the Sword of Protection against a tree. Every step looks like a blooper reel: she trips over roots, forgets which way the enemy is, and waves wildly at butterflies she mistakes for spies. Catra, naturally, can't stop teasing.

"You call that a sword swing? My grandma hits harder than that—and I don't even know her." Adora pouts but giggles.

"Maybe *my* grandma's a secret Horde spy. Or a unicorn." Bow ducks as a stray blast misses his ear.

"Focus, Adora. Just try to stand still for a second." Glimmer casts a protective shield over the group, magic flaring brighter in frustration.

"We're *supposed* to be fighting *them,* not *babysitting you."*

At the worst moment, a battalion of Horde soldiers bursts from the trees. Adora's eyes go wild, then she does the only thing she remembers from training: she *runs,* but right *into* the enemy lines, causing them to scatter, bewildered.

In the chaos, she stumbles sideways into a loose rock, which dislodges and crashes down a slope, toppling a whole pile of Horde weapons and creating a domino effect that clears the path for the princesses.

Catra blinks.

"Did you just… win by accident?" Adora shrugs, grinning like she just won the lottery.

"Maybe I'm a genius." Bow barks out a laugh.

"A genius disaster, sure." Glimmer shakes her head but cracks a smile.

"I may be the queen, but I think we all know who's the real leader right now." Catra leans in close to Adora.

"You're a mess," she whispers, then kisses Adora's nose. "But you're *my* mess." Adora beams, eyes sparkling with innocent chaos, the kind of mess that somehow changes the course of wars.

The sun dips low behind Bright Moon now, painting the sky in peach and violet. The battlefield lies quiet now, scattered with glittering remnants of magic and a few unconscious robots Entrapta laments over, piled suspiciously near a crater that Adora *definitely* didn't mean to cause.

Inside the castle, Adora sits upright on a medical cot, a cold compress perched lopsidedly on her forehead. Her eyes focus. Her posture corrects. Her daisy crown sits forgotten beside a bowl of soup she doesn't remember asking for.

"...Wait. Did I *run* directly at the enemy?" she asks, blinking slowly.

"You *charged* like a malfunctioning Emily with a sword," Catra deadpans from her chair, one foot kicked up on the edge of the bed. "And somehow made it *work.* You *literally* defeated an entire squadron by tripping over your own feet." Adora groans, burying her face in her hands.

"Please tell me I didn't meow."

"You *definitely* meowed," Glimmer says from across the room, arms crossed, a smirk tugging at her lips despite herself. Bow raises a peace-sign from the corner, where he's doodling the incident in a sketchpad already labelled *"Adora: Greatest Woobie Idiot in Etheria".*

"You *were* kinda adorable, though. And extremely confusing to the enemy. Honestly, it was strategic chaos." Adora lets out a long, muffled whine, having moved her face from her hands to her knees.

"I'm never showing my face in public again." Catra leans over and presses a kiss to her temple.

"Oh, please. Everyone loves a good hero story. And now you've got one where you *meowed* your way to victory." She pauses. "...I'm never letting this go." Adora groans louder and flops backward, knocking the soup bowl onto the floor.

And for the first time that day, everything is back to normal.

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